

The CBT Workbook for Beginners - Printable Worksheets

Every worksheet from the book, one per page. Print as many copies as you need.

The Thought Record Card

Situation (the facts) -> **Feelings** (one word, 0-100) -> **Thoughts** (circle the hot one; belief 0-100)

Evidence for (facts only) | **Evidence against** (what would I tell a friend? other explanations? which trap? the most likely outcome, and could I cope?)

Balanced thought (belief 0-100) -> **Feelings now**

The Bad-Day Card

This is a bad day, not a verdict.

Do the first small thing on today's schedule, whether or not I feel like it.

Write the hot thought down. Ask what I would say to a friend.

Worries go on the log for worry time at _____.

Breathe out slowly. Stay. It peaks and passes.

Tell _____ how today went.

Worksheet 3.1 - The PHQ-9 (low mood)

Over the **last two weeks**, how often have you been bothered by the following? Score each: Not at all = 0; Several days = 1; More than half the days = 2; Nearly every day = 3.

	Week 0	Week 3	Week 6
1. Little interest or pleasure in doing things			
2. Feeling down, depressed or hopeless			
3. Trouble falling or staying asleep, or sleeping too much			
4. Feeling tired or having little energy			
5. Poor appetite or overeating			
6. Feeling bad about yourself, or that you are a failure or have let yourself or your family down			
7. Trouble concentrating on things, such as reading the newspaper or watching television			
8. Moving or speaking so slowly that other people could have noticed; or the opposite, being so fidgety or restless that you have been moving around a lot more than usual			

9. Thoughts that you would be better off dead, or of hurting yourself in some way			
Total			

Totals: 0-4 minimal; 5-9 mild; 10-14 moderate; 15-19 moderately severe; 20-27 severe. **If your answer to question 9 is anything other than 0, please talk to your doctor or a crisis line this week, whatever the total.** A total of 15 or more is a reason to see a doctor alongside using this book.

Worksheet 3.2 - The GAD-7 (anxiety)

Over the **last two weeks**, how often have you been bothered by the following? Same scoring.

	Week 0	Week 3	Week 6
1. Feeling nervous, anxious or on edge			
2. Not being able to stop or control worrying			
3. Worrying too much about different things			
4. Trouble relaxing			
5. Being so restless that it is hard to sit still			
6. Becoming easily annoyed or irritable			
7. Feeling afraid as if something awful might happen			
Total			

Totals: 0-4 minimal; 5-9 mild; 10-14 moderate; 15-21 severe.

Worksheet 3.3 - The problem, in my words

What I would most like to be different in six weeks	
The situations where it is worst	
What I have stopped doing, or avoid, because of it	
What I do to feel safer (checking, reassurance, planning, escaping)	
Who knows, and who could support the six weeks	
What I have tried before, and what happened	
Three things I would do if this were better (specific: "walk to the shops alone", "accept the invitation")	

The last line matters most. It is the target.

Worksheet 1.1 - The three-column thought record

Date and time	Situation (the facts)	Feelings (one word each, 0-100)	Thoughts and images (circle the hot thought; belief 0-100)

Worksheet 1.2 - Mood and activity log, Week 1

Day	Mood this evening (0 = worst, 10 = best)	Anxiety (0-10)	What I did today (one line)	Best moment	Worst moment
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

Weekly review

Thought records completed this week	
The feeling that came up most, and its usual strength	
The three hot thoughts that came up most often	
The thinking traps I can already see (Appendix A)	
What the mood log shows: better days and worse days, and what was different about them	
Anxiety or low mood the larger problem this week?	
Ready for Week 2? (at least seven thought records done)	

Worksheet 2.1 - The activity menu

Pleasure (things I enjoy or used to)	Mastery (things that give a sense of achievement)	Connection (people)

My values, and one activity for each: _____

Worksheet 2.2 - The activity schedule, Week 2

Write the plan the night before; rate P (pleasure) and M (mastery) 0-10 afterwards.

Day	Morning (activity; P/M)	Afternoon (activity; P/M)	Evening (activity; P/M)	Mood this evening 0-10
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

Worksheet 2.3 - Graded task

The task I have been avoiding	
Step 1 (so small it is almost silly)	
Step 2	
Step 3	
Step 4	
Step 5	
Predicted difficulty of step 1 (0-10) / actual	

Weekly review

Activities scheduled / activities done	
The activity with the biggest gap between predicted and actual pleasure or mastery	
Mood ratings this week compared with Week 1	
The thoughts that tried to stop me, and what happened when I went anyway	
Connection: people I saw or spoke to	
What to carry into Week 3's schedule (keep scheduling; it continues all program)	

Worksheet 3.1 - The seven-column thought record

Column 5 questions: what would I tell a friend? What are the other explanations? Which trap is this? What is the most likely outcome, and could I cope with it?

Step	
1. Situation	
2. Feelings (0-100)	
3. Thoughts; hot thought; belief	
4. Evidence for	
5. Evidence against	
6. Balanced thought; belief	
7. Feelings now	

Worksheet 3.2 - The seven-column thought record (second copy)

Column 5 questions: what would I tell a friend? What are the other explanations? Which trap is this? What is the most likely outcome, and could I cope with it?

Step	
1. Situation	
2. Feelings (0-100)	
3. Thoughts; hot thought; belief	
4. Evidence for	
5. Evidence against	
6. Balanced thought; belief	
7. Feelings now	

Worksheet 3.3 - My common traps and my questions

Thinking trap (Appendix A)	How often this week	The question that loosens it for me

Weekly review

Full thought records completed	
Average drop in the feeling rating, column 2 to column 7	
The balanced thought I found most convincing, in full	
The hot thought that would not shift, and what I think is underneath it (Week 6)	
Activity schedule kept? Mood ratings this week	
PHQ-9 and GAD-7 at Week 3 (Chapter 3), compared with Week 0	

Worksheet 4.1 - The worry log and worry time

My worry time: _____ each day, at _____ (place).

Day	Worries written down during the day (a few words each)	In worry time: real problem (R) or hypothetical (H)?	Still worried about it at worry time? (yes / gone)
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Worksheet 4.2 - Problem-solving

Step	
1. The problem, in one specific sentence	
2. Every option I can think of (no censoring; at least five)	
3. The pros and cons of the best three	
4. The option I choose	
5. The first step, and when I will take it	
6. What happened, and what next	

Worksheet 4.3 - Tolerating uncertainty

Day	The thing I deliberately left unchecked / unasked / unplanned	Anxiety before (0-100)	Anxiety an hour later	What actually happened
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

Weekly review

Days I kept worry time	
Proportion of logged worries that were hypothetical	
Proportion that had gone stale by worry time	
Real problems solved, and the first steps taken	
The uncertainty experiment that surprised me most	
What I believe now about whether worrying keeps me safe (0-100)	

Worksheet 5.1 - The fear ladder

The fear I am working on: _____

Rung	The step, specifically	Predicted anxiety (0-100)	Safety behaviours to drop	Done (dates)	Anxiety start / peak / end
1 (easiest)					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10 (the full thing)					

Worksheet 5.2 - My safety behaviours

What I do to feel safer	In which situations	What it stops me finding out	Dropped on

Worksheet 5.3 - Behavioural experiments

Date	The step	My prediction (and how much I believe it, 0- 100)	What actually happened	What I learned; belief in the prediction now

Weekly review

Exposures done this week, and the highest rung reached	
The prediction that was most wrong	
Safety behaviours dropped	
Anxiety at the start of the first exposure / at the end of the last	
What I now believe about my ability to cope with the feared situation (0-100)	
Next rungs for the coming weeks (the ladder continues after the program)	

Worksheet 6.1 - The downward arrow, and my rules

A hot thought that keeps coming back	
If that were true, what would it mean about me?	
And if that were true?	
And if that were true?	
The core belief, in a few words; belief 0-100	
The rules that follow ("If... then..."; "I must...")	
Where I think it came from	

Worksheet 6.2 - Testing the belief

The old belief	
Evidence that seems to support it (across my life)	
Evidence against it, including the things the belief made me overlook	
An alternative belief that fits all the evidence	
Belief in the old (0-100) / in the alternative (0-100), today	

Worksheet 6.3 - The positive data log

The alternative belief: _____

Date	Evidence today that supports it (small counts)

Worksheet 6.4 - My blueprint

What the problem was, and how it kept itself going (the loop)	
What I learned that helped most	
The tools that work for me, in order (activity scheduling / thought records / worry time / exposure / breathing / the data log)	
My thinking traps, and the questions that loosen them	
My early warning signs of a bad patch	
What I will do in the first week of a bad patch (specific)	
What I will keep doing every week, now	
The people who support this, and what I will tell them	
The next fear ladder or goal	
PHQ-9: Week 0 ____ Week 6 ____ GAD-7: Week 0 ____ Week 6 ____	

Weekly review

The core belief I found, and how much I believe it now compared with the start of the week	
The alternative belief, in full	
The rule I tested, and what happened	
Entries in the positive data log	
The blueprint written and copied (one for the wall, one for the folder)	
The program as a whole: what changed, what did not, what next (Chapter 7)	

Worksheet 7.1 - My bad-week card

My early warning signs (three)	
The first thing I will do (specific, small, tomorrow morning)	
The person I will tell	
The tool that worked best last time	
The thought that will try to stop me, and the balanced answer I found for it	
When I will get more help (the score, the date)	

Worksheet 9.1 - My help plan

My doctor / practice, and how to book	
A crisis line I have saved (988 in the US; 116 123 in the UK and Ireland; findahelpline.com elsewhere)	
Medicines I take for mood or anxiety, and the prescriber	
Whether I want to look for a therapist, and where I will look	
The score or the sign at which I will make the appointment	
The person who will come with me, or who knows	

Blank three-column thought record

Date and time	Situation (the facts)	Feelings (0-100)	Thoughts and images; hot thought circled; belief (0-100)

Blank seven-column thought record

Column 5 questions: what would I tell a friend? What are the other explanations? Which trap is this? What is the most likely outcome, and could I cope with it?

Step	
1. Situation	
2. Feelings (0-100)	
3. Thoughts; hot thought; belief	
4. Evidence for	
5. Evidence against	
6. Balanced thought; belief	
7. Feelings now	

Blank activity schedule

Day	Morning (activity; P/M)	Afternoon (activity; P/M)	Evening (activity; P/M)	Mood 0-10
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

Blank worry log

Day	Worries written down	Real or hypothetical	Gone by worry time?
Mon			
Tue			
Wed			
Thu			
Fri			
Sat			
Sun			

Blank behavioural experiment record

Date	The step	Prediction (belief 0-100)	What happened	What I learned; belief now

The twelve-week tracker

Week	PHQ-9	GAD-7	Activities done	Thought records	Exposures / experiments	Notes
0						
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						

12						
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